

Twitter Granny

104-year old Ivy Bean from the UK has over 45,000 followers on Twitter!

Rememberthemilk.com

An Adode Air notifier and an effective to-do list. It works in sync with various mobile platforms and Google Calendar

A curious case for anonymity

Traditionally darknets have always been regarded as the dark underbelly of the internet, but now it seems as if accessing a darknet will be as simple as having a web browser. HP researchers recently demonstrated a darknet - essentially a closed private network - that can be accessed through a browser. Some earlier darknets such as Freenet, Tor and WASTE have gained notoriety for having all sorts of objectionable content supported by the veil of anonymity they provide. These darknets need a client to access them. Finding such clients installed on laptops would often raise alarm bells for security authorities as they can be used for virtually untraceable communication aiding even terrorists.

The HP researchers however say darknets have their legitimate uses. Their creation aptly named 'Veiled' can be used for anonymous whistle blowing and will also bring anonymous communication to the mainstream. Darknets maintain anonymity by scattering files as fragments across thousands of servers. They also use something known as onion routing that tunnels communication through a network of relays so web sites can't determine your location. In a podcast with Security Wire Weekly, Matt Wood one of the developers of Veiled said, "We're leveraging what browsers have become lately, to access some of the functionality offered by darknets".

A simple PHP file is supposed to connect the client to the rest of the darknet. The user on the other hand has to just go to a URL. The PHP file downloads Javascript code into the browser. To understand this concept imagine a whole bunch of servers with this one PHP file on them. All of these PHP files together create the infrastructure for the Veiled darknet. Clients will then connect to each

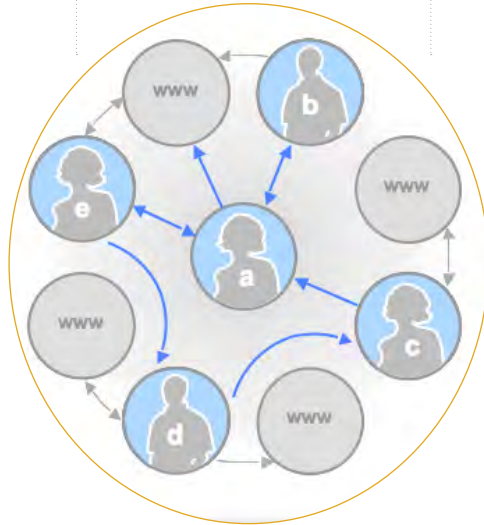
one of those nodes. The PHP files act as repeaters to all the Javascript clients out there. The Javascript is the one doing all the communication between clients. If, for instance, a chat were to be sent out, it would be dispersed among the darknet users. There is going to be encryption involved too. The best part is once you close your browser, your footprint vanishes instantly. It should be interesting to keep an eye on this to see if any productive applications do come out of it.

People research simplified

An interesting Firefox extension we came across a while back was Identity whose description is at once scary and promising; depending on which side of the fence you look at it. The extension is a social media marketer or compulsive social networker's dream come true. But this means it may be a cyber stalker's punching bag as well. The extension can amazingly track identities of individuals across various social network / media sites and create a profile

about just about anyone.

Consider you access a random Twitter profile. After installing the add-on, all you need to do is hit [Ctrl] + [I] and it will build a detailed profile comprising various identities



Identify using 'me' links to track profiles

of that person on other social networking web sites. How does it do this? It uses two APIs. The first is the Google Social Graph API. This Google project started more than a year ago identifies pages that form profiles of people and tracks linkages between pages connected to a

single person. The Yahoo Query Language API manages the extension's data backend.

Identify is therefore programmed to look up info for any page that has the rel="me" code in the source.

The 'me' annotation is part of the XFN (XHTML Friends Network) and FOAF (Friend of a Friend) markups, which are crawled by the Google Social Graph API. The tool can be very useful to learn more about people and their trademark internet handles. Running it on your own profile can be shocking or perhaps even disappointing if it fails to get the lowdown on you. This way, it helps you fine tune your profile if you want a more integrated web presence. Or help people in disassociating profiles that they don't want linked together. The

only hitch is that it requires some work by the developers and doesn't work really well currently.

Monopoly in the sky

No, we're not talking about Airline Moguls. We're talking about one of the world's most



Monopoly city streets